MCP PRODUCTION · SPEC REVISION 2026-07-28

MCP 2026 revision impact — standalone reference

The revision impact sheet from lesson 9.1: each assumption a 2025-11-25 server can hold, how the stateless revision behaves instead, and the deprecation clock.

Checked 2026-09-10 against revision 2026-07-28 and the earlier 2025-11-25 lifecycle. No lab or previous lesson is needed for this diagnostic.

EXISTING ASSUMPTION	TARGET-REVISION BEHAVIOR	FIRST THING TO INSPECT
Initialize once, retain capabilities	Version/capabilities on every request	`_meta` construction for each call
Session ID carries application selection	Protocol sessions removed	Explicit project/work handle and access checks
Server sends its own approval request	Input request returned in original result	Retry with inputResponses and opaque requestState
Every response finishes the operation	Required resultType distinguishes interim results	Branch on complete/input_required
Any 400 means an earlier server	Modern failures also use 400	Error code and supported-version data
GET stream or Last-Event-ID recovers messages	Those mechanisms removed from target Streamable HTTP	POST response/subscription and operation recovery
All deprecated features disappeared	Deprecated features remain during their window	Per-feature registry and normative notice

SSE itself has not disappeared: the target can return a request-scoped SSE response and subscriptions/listen has an SSE response stream. The older HTTP+SSE transport is a distinct compatibility path.

`clientInfo` is optional; version and clientCapabilities are required. An earlier server's result without resultType is treated as complete. Discovery is mandatory for target servers but optional for clients. Stateless protocol context does not remove the need to persist application work.

Deprecation is not immediate removal

Roots, Sampling, Logging and Dynamic Client Registration are Deprecated in this revision. Their registry row gives earliest eligibility as the first Current revision released on or after 2027-07-28. That is not an announced removal date. The historical HTTP+SSE transport has a different transition rule, tied to three months after SEP-2596 Final; do not assign it the same anniversary. includeContext thisServer/allServers follows Sampling. Recheck notices before setting deadlines.

The policy's normal twelve-month floor also has an approved expedited-removal exception with a minimum ninety-day interval under its stated active-risk conditions. SDK support can follow a different timeline from specification removal.

Practice and answer key

1. A call gets HTTP 400 with error -32020. Must the client initialize? **Answer:** No. This identifies a modern header mismatch; inspect and repair the request instead of treating a status alone as an era detector.
2. A server needs approval before adding a note. Does removing callbacks remove the approval requirement? **Answer:** No. Preserve the business boundary and deliver the input request through MRTR; a simulated answer is not human proof.
3. A team schedules automatic feature shutdown on 2027-07-28. Does the registry mandate that? **Answer:** No. It names eligibility in a subsequent Current revision, not a scheduled removal. Use a dated feature-specific record.
4. A service uses SSE responses today. Must all SSE code be deleted? **Answer:** No. Distinguish response streams still supported by the target from the removed GET/session/resume mechanisms and the older transport.

Primary sources

- Revision changes
- Earlier lifecycle
- Compatibility
- HTTP binding
- Deprecated registry
- Lifecycle policy

> **Where this goes next.** Module 9 moves a 2025-11-25 server to 2026-07-28 with compatibility fixtures, explicit handles in place of sessions and a staged rollout plan, in lab 9. The course: runsclean.com/courses/mcp-production/